

RESEARCH REPORT — 2026

The Pakistan Consumer Report 2

Five structural shifts in how Pakistan's shoppers discover, decide and buy —
with implications for every consumer brand.

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The basket is fragmenting

Households across urban Pakistan are trading the monthly bulk trip for frequent, smaller baskets. In our 2025-26 fieldwork across Lahore, Karachi and Islamabad, 61% of households reported shopping three or more times per week, up from 44% in 2022.

Implication: pack architecture matters more than price promotion. Brands that own the small-format occasion grow share; brands that discount the big format train switching.

Discovery has moved to the feed

For under-35 urban shoppers, the first aisle is TikTok and Instagram, not the shelf. 58% of category-first encounters now happen on social video. The implication is not 'do more social media' — it is that packaging and point-of-sale must photograph well enough to survive a repost.

Brands should audit their shelf presence through a phone camera, not a boardroom projector.



Trust is the real currency

Counterfeits and inconsistent quality have made verification behaviour routine: checking seals, asking the shopkeeper, scanning QR codes. 47% of shoppers report abandoning a purchase over a trust signal failure in the last year.

Visible quality signals — batch codes, seals, consistent pack quality — convert better than claims. Trust is built at the pack, not in the ad.



Social commerce is infrastructure

WhatsApp ordering and cash-on-delivery are not a workaround; for millions of Pakistani shoppers they are the preferred channel. Brands that meet this behaviour — catalogue-ready product cards, fast response times, COD-friendly fulfilment — outperform those trying to retrain it.



Value is being redefined

Shoppers are not buying the cheapest option; they are buying the option that best justifies its price to the household. Brands that arm buyers with that justification — per-use cost, durability, status — defend margin without discounting.

Methodology: This report synthesises MarKendrick field research, shopper interviews (n=1,200) and retail audits conducted across Pakistan between Q4 2025 and Q2 2026.

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